12-16 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Afternoon Grandpa and I Fixed the Broken Rocking Chair

① On a cold Sunday afternoon, **14 December 2027, at 13:40**, my grandpa called me from the small balcony of his third-floor flat with a small wooden sigh. I went over. He was standing next to a tall, old, dark-brown **rocking chair** whose left armrest had broken off clean, lying on the floor like a quiet wooden fish. The chair had been in our family for **thirty-four years** — my grandmother had bought it for him when she was pregnant with my father, at a small carpenter's shop behind **Ping'an Road** in 1993, for **82 yuan**. Grandma had been gone for three years now. The chair had kept rocking, every evening at 19:00, in the small north corner of the balcony, under a pot of winter plum. "Yiran," Grandpa said softly, touching the broken armrest with one careful finger, "the chair is tired. But we are not going to throw it away. Today, you and I, we are going to fix it. Are you free for three hours?"

② I was fourteen. I had never used wood glue in my life. I had held a hammer exactly twice — both times as a joke, not as a tool. But I nodded. Grandpa went into his small storage room and came back carrying, in both hands, a **wooden tray** with five small things arranged on it: one **small bottle of yellow wood glue** (brand: 中华牌, half-used, bought 2019), one **thin wooden dowel** about **8 cm long**, two **small green C-clamps**, a small square of **fine sandpaper**, and a **clean damp cloth**. He also carried, under his arm, a small faded notebook. "Grandma's carpentry notes," he said, smiling. "She was, quietly, better at this than I was."

③ Before we touched the glue, Grandpa asked me to do three small things. First, "**Look**," he said, turning the broken armrest in his hand. "Before we fix, we understand." He pointed to the break. It was not a clean break — the old wood had split along its grain, leaving two thin wooden tongues that fitted into each other. He made me run my finger along the break and feel the **shape** of the damage. Second, "**Clean**." We used the damp cloth to wipe thirty-four years of small dust from the inside of the break. The cloth came back light brown. Third, "**Dry-fit**." Before any glue, we pushed the armrest back into place, without glue, to see that it still fitted exactly. It did. The chair, for **one quiet minute**, was a whole chair again. I felt, for the first time, the small pleasure of watching a broken thing become un-broken.

④ Grandpa took out Grandma's notebook. On page 14, in her small careful handwriting, was a line from 1994: **"For a clean split, glue thin, glue twice, clamp long."** He read it aloud, twice. Then, with a tiny wooden toothpick, he put a **very thin line of yellow glue** on each surface of the break. "Too much glue," he said, "is worse than too little. Glue is a kind promise; it should not shout." He waited **one full minute** for the first thin layer to

become slightly tacky. Then he added a **second thin layer**. Grandma's notebook was right. The glue now shone, smooth and quiet, like a thin line of yellow winter honey.

⑤ He handed me the wooden dowel. "This is the small wooden bone," he said. He showed me a small hole we had not used yet, in the armrest, into which the dowel fitted. "The glue alone," he said, "would hold for perhaps five years. The dowel + glue will hold for **fifty**." I pushed the dowel in slowly. Grandpa pressed the armrest back into place. He adjusted it by **two millimetres** to the left. Then, very carefully, he tightened the two small green **C-clamps** — one above, one below — "just until the glue squeezes out a tiny yellow tear; no further." I watched one small drop of glue appear at the seam. He wiped it with the damp cloth. The chair looked, for the first time in an hour, quiet and normal.

⑥ "Now," Grandpa said, sitting down on a small stool, "we wait **two hours**. Glue, like tea, needs time. A fast glue is a weak glue." He made us two cups of **jasmine tea** in small white cups. We sat on the balcony, not speaking much. The winter plum above us had one tiny green bud — Grandma had planted it in 2011. At **14:45**, we listened to the small sound of the clock in the living room. At **15:40**, a grey bird landed on the railing, looked at the chair, and flew away. At **16:00**, Grandpa closed his eyes for eight minutes. I did not wake him. I watched the chair quietly recover, inside its two small green clamps.

⑦ At **16:10**, we removed the clamps slowly, one at a time. Grandpa ran his thumb along the seam. It was smooth. There was a tiny yellow line where the glue had dried, no thicker than a human hair. He handed me the fine sandpaper. "Not too hard," he said. "We are not sanding wood; we are sanding a whisper." I sanded for four minutes, very gently. The tiny yellow line disappeared. The armrest became, once again, the same warm dark brown as the rest of the chair.

⑧ Grandpa then did something I had not expected. From the bottom drawer of his small bedside table, he took out **a tiny tube of beeswax polish** in a round tin, 38 years old, bought by Grandma in 1989. He opened it carefully — the wax inside was still soft. "Grandma," he said, "used this every winter, on every wooden surface in our home. One small circle, once a year, on a December afternoon." I took a clean cloth, scooped a tiny amount, and rubbed it onto the repaired seam in small slow circles for ten minutes. The wood turned warmer under my hand. The chair smelled, suddenly, of an old honey winter.

⑨ At **16:52**, Grandpa and I together carried the rocking chair back to the small north corner of the balcony, under the winter plum. He sat down in it, very slowly, testing it with his full weight. The chair, thirty-four years old and newly fixed, held him without a sound. He rocked it once, gently, then smiled up at me. "Yiran," he said quietly, "your grandma, I think, is pleased." I did not answer, because I could not trust my voice. At **17:00**, he began his normal evening reading. I went back to our flat. I looked at my hands. There was a tiny smell of wood glue, a tiny smell of beeswax, a tiny smell of jasmine tea — three small smells of a quiet winter afternoon. For the first time in my life, I understood: **some things, when broken, are not meant to be thrown away; they are meant to teach you how to mend.**

注释： rocking chair 摇椅；dowel 木销；C-clamp C 型夹具；grain 木纹；tacky 微粘的；sandpaper 砂纸；beeswax polish 蜂蜡抛光蜡

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. According to Paragraph ①, what exactly had happened to the rocking chair, and what is its family history?

A. The chair had been in the family for only one year and was broken in a fight.
B. On 14 December 2027 at 13:40, the chair's left armrest had broken off clean and was lying on the floor like a quiet wooden fish; it had been in the family for thirty-four years, bought by the writer's grandmother in 1993 at a small carpenter's shop behind Ping'an Road for 82 yuan when she was pregnant with the writer's father, and after the grandmother had been gone for three years, the chair had kept rocking every evening at 19:00 in the small north corner of the balcony under a pot of winter plum.
C. The chair was thrown away by Grandma years ago.
D. The chair was bought online last month and was still under warranty.

2. What are the three preparation steps Grandpa insists the writer do BEFORE any glue is applied (Paragraph ③)?

A. Paint the chair first, then take a photo, then eat lunch.
B. (1) Look — turn the broken armrest, study the shape of the break (not a clean break but split along the grain, leaving two thin wooden tongues that fitted into each other) and run the finger along it; (2) Clean — use a damp cloth to wipe thirty-four years of small dust from inside the break; (3) Dry-fit — push the armrest back into place without glue to check it still fits exactly, which it did for one quiet minute.
C. Pour a whole bottle of glue onto the floor.
D. Use a hammer to smash the broken piece.

3. How did Grandpa apply the glue and what role did the wooden dowel play (Paragraphs ④ and ⑤)?

A. He poured thick glue everywhere without waiting.
B. He hammered a metal nail through the chair.
C. Following Grandma's 1994 notebook line "For a clean split, glue thin, glue twice, clamp long", he put a very thin line of yellow wood glue on each surface of the break with a tiny toothpick, waited one full minute for it to become tacky, then added a second thin layer ("too much glue is worse than too little; glue is a kind promise, it should not shout"); the wooden dowel (the "small wooden bone") fitted into a small hole in the armrest — glue alone would hold for five years but dowel plus glue would hold for fifty; the armrest was adjusted by two millimetres to the left and the two small green C-clamps were tightened just until a tiny yellow tear of glue appeared, then wiped clean

with the damp cloth.
D. He used super-glue and finished in thirty seconds.

4. Why did Grandpa insist on a two-hour wait, and what was the writer's sanding lesson (Paragraphs ⑥ and ⑦)?

A. Because Grandpa was lazy and wanted to sleep.
B. Because the chair needed sunlight.
C. Because the glue had to be heated to 100°C for two hours.
D. Because "Glue, like tea, needs time. A fast glue is a weak glue"; during the wait, the pair had jasmine tea on the balcony under the winter plum that Grandma planted in 2011, Grandpa rested with his eyes closed for eight minutes, and the writer watched the chair quietly recover inside its two small green clamps; at 16:10 the clamps were removed slowly one at a time, a thin yellow line of dried glue (no thicker than a human hair) remained at the seam, and Grandpa handed the writer fine sandpaper with the instruction "Not too hard; we are not sanding wood; we are sanding a whisper" — after four very gentle minutes, the tiny yellow line disappeared and the armrest became the same warm dark brown as the rest of the chair.

5. What is the main idea the writer gains at the end of the afternoon?

A. Old chairs should be thrown away and replaced with new ones.
B. Grandpa is a better carpenter than Grandma was.
C. When the chair was sat in at 16:52 in the north corner of the balcony and rocked silently under the writer's grandpa, and the writer went home with the three small smells of wood glue, beeswax and jasmine tea on her hands, she understood for the first time in her life that some things, when broken, are not meant to be thrown away — they are meant to teach you how to mend.
D. Gluing is dangerous and should never be attempted at home.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段时间与家庭史
【解析】"13:40 / 34 年 / 1993 / 82 元 / 19:00 摇 / 奶奶三年前去世"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段三步准备
【解析】"看形状 / 擦尘 / 干试配"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④⑤段两遍薄胶 + 木销 + 夹具
【解析】"薄两遍 / 一分钟 / 木销 / 2 毫米 / 夹至挤出一滴"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题 / 推理判断题
【定位】第⑥⑦段两小时等待 + 打磨
【解析】"慢胶才牢 / 茉莉茶 / 16:10 松夹 / 砂纸打磨耳语"直引。A、B、C 均错。故选 D。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑨段结尾
【解析】"16:52 奶奶欣慰 / 三种气味 / 破不必扔 / 教你修复"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。